

# The Pastons

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The Pastons were a Norfolk family famous for their letters, written between 1422 and 1509, which provide a rare glimpse into life during the Wars of the Roses and early Tudor period. They were ambitious lawyers who acquired significant property in Norfolk and Suffolk but spent much time in London defending their estates. Most letters were written by the women, especially Margaret Paston, about managing estates, rents, disputes, and family matters.

William Paston (1378–1444) became a Justice of the Common Pleas and married the heiress Agnes Barr. His son John (1421–1466) continued the legal work, including handling Caister Castle for the wealthy Sir John Falstaff. John's son, Sir John Paston (1442–1479), finally secured Caister after disputes. The family remained prominent landowners until the early 18th century, maintaining strong connections with London and Fleet Street, where several Pastons lived, worked, and studied law.



*The Paston Treasure. An enigmatic painting from around 1466, showing some of the valuable possessions of the Paston family, held in Norwich Castle Museum*